4. ***Armaments and Disarmaments:*** Military power is vital for the survival of a state and is directly linked to the maintenance of the security of that particular state. Therefore, states put great emphasis on their military preparedness, either in terms of their conventional forces or nuclear arsenal. The fact is that military preparedness of one state makes it a necessity for another state to follow the suit. This leads to a perilous and unending arms race and intensified rivalries among the major powers, as it had happened in the post-War era between the United States and the Soviet Union, and as it happens in every part of the globe. India and Pakistan are again contenders in the South Asian region and arms race between them tends to disturb the balance in the region. India, vis-à-vis its neighbour to match the Chinese prowess, pursues a policy of improvising and adding to its military arsenal, conventional and nuclear armaments, which again is most likely to send shocks to her South Asian neighbours, especially Pakistan, and escalate an arms race in the region.

But constant arms race increases the fear of destruction. Therefore, in theory, a more stable balance of power can be attained by ending the armament race and proportionately reducing the armaments. The first effort towards disarmament was the Treaty of Versailles of 1919 and then the Washington Naval Treaty of 1922. Following the reduction of tension between the two superpowers, both have attempted to reduce their armament efforts and have signed many accord in this regard like the Partial Test Ban Treaty (PTBT) of 1963, Strategic Arms Limitation Treaty (SALT-I) of 1972 and SALT-II of 1979, Intermediate Range Nuclear Force (INF) Treaty of 1987 and the Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (START) of 1991. Globally, several disarmament efforts have also been taken up by the United Nations, such as the Non Proliferation Treaty (NPT), Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty (CTBT), the Chemical Weapons Treaty and others. But the problem with disarmament is that the state, which disarms first, runs a serious risk. Therefore, disarmament is often discussed and its practice involves difficulties until there are assurances that all will disarm together in such a way that it will not disturb the current distribution of power. As this assurance is lacking in most cases, disarmament measures are looked upon with suspicion and this is